08-21 第1篇

阅读理解（说明文） How Do Dolphins Really "Talk" to Each Other?

① If you have ever watched **dolphins** at a sea park, you may have heard sharp clicks, long squeaks, and high whistles coming from the water. Visitors often laugh and say, "The dolphins are talking to each other!" But is it really a kind of language? In the past fifty years, scientists have taken this question very seriously. Today, most marine biologists agree: dolphins have one of the richest communication systems in the animal world.

② To understand how dolphins talk, we first need to understand how they **hear**. Sound travels **about four times faster** in water than in air, and it can reach much further. For sea creatures, sound is often more useful than sight, because the sea is not always clear. Dolphins use their sharp sense of hearing both to find food and to "speak" with their friends.

③ Dolphins make mainly **three kinds of sounds**. The first kind is a fast **click**. Each click is very short, like "tak-tak-tak". These clicks are used for **echolocation**: the click travels out, bounces off a fish or a rock, and comes back to the dolphin's head. From the time and shape of the returning sound, the dolphin's brain draws a quick "sound picture" of the world around it — a bit like a living ship radar. That is why a dolphin can find a small fish even in dark or cloudy water.

④ The second kind is the **whistle**. Scientists have found that every young dolphin develops its own **"signature whistle"** within the first few months of life — a small, special tune that belongs only to that dolphin. When two dolphins meet in the sea, they often exchange their signature whistles. Researchers say this is similar to humans saying their own name: "I am Lily." "I am Tom." If one dolphin is far away in the water, other members of the group may still call it by its whistle, just as a mother might call her child's name in a busy street.

⑤ The third kind is a soft, **squeaking sound** used inside a close group. These sounds are often sent between a mother and her baby, or between good friends. Scientists do not fully understand these quiet signals, but recording machines show that such sounds become more common when the dolphins are playing, grooming each other, or solving a small problem together.

⑥ Some dolphin groups, called **pods**, also use body language. A slap of the tail on the surface can be a warning. A sudden jump out of the water may be a signal for others to gather. Scientists at one Florida research centre saw a wild pod all line up and turn in

the same direction after the leader slapped its tail three times — almost as if it were giving an order.

⑦ One reason dolphins are able to say so much is that their **brain is large and cleverly shaped**, with many folds. In several experiments, trained dolphins could understand simple human hand signals like "fetch the red ball" and even **understand the difference** between "bring the ball to the ring" and "bring the ring to the ball".

⑧ Of course, dolphins do not have a grammar book or write stories. Whether we should call their system a true "language" is still an open question among scientists. But one thing is clear: next time you hear a dolphin whistle, remember — it is **not just a cute noise**. It may be a little dolphin saying hello, calling a friend's name, or telling its mother, "I am right here."

注释： marine 海洋的；echolocation 回声定位；signature 签名的、标志性的；pod 海豚群

根据文章内容，选择最佳答案。

1. Why is sound very useful for sea animals like dolphins?

A. Because sound cannot travel well in water.
B. Because sound travels about four times faster in water than in air, and can reach much further than sight in unclear water.
C. Because dolphins have weak hearing.
D. Because light travels faster under water than sound.

2. What does a dolphin mainly use fast clicks for?

A. To say hello to human visitors.
B. For echolocation — clicks bounce off objects and return, helping the dolphin "see" with sound.
C. To open the gate of the sea park.
D. To sleep at night.

3. What is a dolphin's "signature whistle"?

A. A sound all dolphins make the same way.
B. A special tune each dolphin develops within the first few months of life that works almost like its own name.
C. A sound made only by old dolphins to warn the young.
D. A noise used only during storms.

4. In the Florida observation, what happened after the leader dolphin slapped its tail three times?

A. The leader swam away alone.
B. The other dolphins refused to move.
C. The whole wild pod lined up and turned in the same direction, almost as if following an order.
D. The leader began to dance above the water.

5. What is the writer's main opinion about dolphin sounds by the end of the passage?

A. Dolphin sounds are only "cute noises" with no real meaning.
B. It is still debated whether we can call it a true language, but dolphin sounds are clearly rich and meaningful — they say hello, call names, and share feelings.
C. Dolphins cannot really communicate at all.
D. Only humans can have any real communication system.

答案与解析

1.
【答案】B
【题型】细节理解题
【定位】第②段 "Sound travels about four times faster in water than in air, and it can reach much further"
【解析】原文明确水下声速是空气中约 4 倍，且能传得更远。A、C、D 均与原文不符。故选 B。

2.
【答案】B
【题型】细节理解题
【定位】第③段 "These clicks are used for echolocation"
【解析】快速咔嗒声用于回声定位。A、C、D 均无依据。故选 B。

3.
【答案】B
【题型】细节理解题
【定位】第④段 "every young dolphin develops its own 'signature whistle' within the first few months of life ... similar to humans saying their own name"
【解析】个性化口哨相当于"自己的名字"。A、C、D 均与原文不符。故选 B。

4.
【答案】C
【题型】细节理解题
【定位】第⑥段 "all line up and turn in the same direction after the leader slapped its tail three times"
【解析】原文直接描述群体动作。A、B、D 均与原文不符。故选 C。

5.
【答案】B
【题型】写作态度题
【定位】第⑧段 "Whether we should call their system a true 'language' is still an open question ... it is not just a cute noise ... saying hello, calling a friend's name ..."
【解析】作者承认"是否是真正语言"仍有争论，但确定海豚的声音富有意义。A、C、D 均与作者立场相反。故选 B。